

Grammar Entry Test

50 multiple-choice questions from Cambridge Grammar for IELTS

Assess your grammar level before you start studying

About This Test

Covers all major grammar points: tenses, modals, articles, conditionals, prepositions, relative clauses, and more.

Each question has three options (A, B, C). Choose one correct answer.

Scoring

0–15 correct — Needs fundamental grammar work (Units 1–10)

16–30 correct — Solid intermediate grammar (Units 11–25)

31–40 correct — Upper-intermediate range (Units 26–40)

41–50 correct — Advanced — near-native grammar control

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Entry Test

You can do this test before using the book to help you choose what to study. Choose the correct answer, A, B or C, for each question.

1. Most university students _____ on campus in their first year.
A lives
B live
C are living
2. From this graph we can see that the economy _____ at the moment.
A improves
B improve
C is improving
3. They _____ personal computers when my father was a student.
A hadn't
B didn't have
C weren't having
4. I _____ want to be a practising doctor but now I'm more interested in research.
A was used to
B used to
C would
5. The teacher _____ us how to do the experiment when the fire bell rang.
A showed
B shown
C was showing
6. I finished my essay yesterday but _____ it in to the tutor yet.
A I've given
B I haven't given
C I didn't give
7. _____ the experiment three times now with different results each time!
A We've done
B We did
C We've been doing
8. When I arrived the lecture _____ so I didn't find it easy to follow.
A started
B had started
C had been starting
9. She _____ well at school but that changed when she became friends with a different group of girls.
A did
B had done
C had been doing
10. _____ the doctor at 2.00 this afternoon so I can't go to the lecture.
A I'm seeing
B I see
C I will see
11. My sister _____ economics and politics when she goes to university.
A is going to study
B studies
C will study
12. While we're working on the project our boss _____ on a beach in Greece!
A will sit
B will have sat
C will be sitting
13. If the trend continues, the average income _____ by 107% by 2020.
A will increase
B will have increased

C will be increasing

14. You can base your geography assignment on _____ country — it doesn't matter which.
A a
B some
C any
15. There aren't _____ places left on the course so you'd better apply soon.
A much
B many
C lots of
16. I don't know whether to accept the job offer. It's _____.
A a difficult decision
B the difficult decision
C difficult decision
17. For those of you new to the company, this leaflet is full of _____.
A a valuable information
B the valuable information
C valuable information
18. The manager interviewed _____ candidates in turn.
A each of the
B each
C every
19. I know it's not much of a present but I made it _____.
A me
B myself
C by myself
20. You should visit Bath. It's _____ city.
A a historical and interesting
B a historical interesting
C an interesting historical
21. The government has released some _____ data showing how schools are not providing an adequate education to our children.
A shocking
B shock
C shocked
22. You really should go to Namibia. The scenery is _____ stunning and the people are very friendly.
A very
B fairly
C absolutely
23. This factory produces some of _____ cameras in the world.
A best
B the best
C the most best
24. _____ people live in the countryside than 100 years ago.
A Less
B Few
C Fewer
25. The bookshop _____ the end of the road is excellent.
A at
B on
C in
26. There were millions of people around the world _____ the football match live on television.
A watched
B watching
C were watching
27. Scientists finally _____ find a cure for the disease after years of research.

- A managed to
- B can
- C could

28. She got a terrible mark in the exam so she _____ very hard at all.

- A mustn't have worked
- B can't have worked
- C didn't work

29. What _____ in order to get a permit to work in your country?

- A do I need to do
- B must I do
- C ought I do

30. When you write your essays you _____ copy ideas from books without referencing them properly.

- A mustn't
- B don't have to
- C have to

31. Doctors have _____ us to cut down on salt in our diets if we want to reduce the risk of getting heart disease.

- A insisted
- B suggested
- C advised

32. _____ this newspaper report, more women smoke than men nowadays.

- A Apparently
- B According to
- C Supposedly

33. My parents encouraged _____ this course.

- A me to do
- B me doing
- C me do

34. What will you do if _____?

- A you don't get a good IELTS score
- B you didn't get a good IELTS score
- C you won't get a good IELTS score

35. A recent government report has warned that _____ we act immediately to reduce pollution, there will be serious consequences for the planet.

- A provided that
- B in case
- C unless

36. If I didn't have to work tonight, _____.

- A I'd be able to relax now
- B I'm able to relax now
- C I'll be able to relax now

37. I wish that man _____ tapping his fingers on the table. It's really annoying me.

- A stopped
- B had stopped
- C would stop

38. I'm aiming _____ a band 7 in IELTS.

- A on
- B for
- C to

39. Do you have any knowledge _____ how our education system works?

- A of
- B on
- C for

40. The minister _____ is responsible for education has just resigned.

- A which
- B who
- C what

41. The University of St Andrews, _____, is the oldest university in Scotland.
A which was founded in 1413
B , which was founded in 1413,
C , that was founded in 1413,
42. Many children these days do not have a healthy diet. _____ is possible that this is because less healthy foods are cheaper than healthy ones.
A What
B That
C It
43. The charity is trying to find ways to save and _____ the world's endangered animal species.
A the charity is trying to find ways to protect
B to find ways to protect
C protect
44. In the past we threw a lot of our kitchen waste away, but today many items such as plastic bottles and newspapers _____.
A are recycled
B recycle
C need recycling
45. I can't pick you up from the station on Wednesday because _____ on that day.
A I'm fixing my car
B I'm having my car fixed
C I need my car fixed
46. These drugs are the best medicine available as a treatment at the moment, _____ they are expensive, unfortunately.
A although
B because
C so
47. Learning a foreign language is important because it helps you to understand other cultures better. _____, it can be a useful skill in many areas of work.
A However,
B Despite this,
C In addition,
48. _____, I can't go to the conference as I've got to go to Sydney on business.
A Frankly
B Unfortunately
C Personally
49. _____, I think it's useful to write an outline of your essay before you start to write the first draft.
A Interestingly,
B Definitely,
C Personally,
50. The _____ of dark red spots is one of the first signs of the disease.
A appearance
B appearing
C appear

End of test. Check your answers on the next page.

Answer Key

Circle your score for each correct answer. Total at the bottom.

1. B | A lives | **B live** | C are living
2. C | A improves | B improve | **C is improving**
3. B | A hadn't | **B didn't have** | C weren't having
4. B | A was used to | **B used to** | C would
5. C | A showed | B shown | **C was showing**
6. B | A I've given | **B I haven't given** | C I didn't give
7. A | **A We've done** | B We did | C We've been doing
8. B | A started | **B had started** | C had been starting
9. C | A did | B had done | **C had been doing**
10. A | **A I'm seeing** | B I see | C I will see
11. A | **A is going to study** | B studies | C will study
12. C | A will sit | B will have sat | **C will be sitting**
13. B | A will increase | **B will have increased** | C will be increasing
14. C | A a | B some | **C any**
15. B | A much | **B many** | C lots of
16. A | **A a difficult decision** | B the difficult decision | C difficult decision
17. C | A a valuable information | B the valuable information | **C valuable information**
18. A | **A each of the** | B each | C every
19. B | A me | **B myself** | C by myself
20. C | A a historical and interesting | B a historical interesting | **C an interesting historical**
21. A | **A shocking** | B shock | C shocked
22. C | A very | B fairly | **C absolutely**
23. B | A best | **B the best** | C the most best
24. C | A Less | B Few | **C Fewer**
25. A | **A at** | B on | C in
26. B | A watched | **B watching** | C were watching
27. A | **A managed to** | B can | C could
28. B | A mustn't have worked | **B can't have worked** | C didn't work
29. A | **A do I need to do** | B must I do | C ought I do
30. A | **A mustn't** | B don't have to | C have to
31. C | A insisted | B suggested | **C advised**
32. B | A Apparently | **B According to** | C Supposedly
33. A | **A me to do** | B me doing | C me do
34. A | **A you don't get a good IELTS score** | B you didn't get a good IELTS score | C you won't get a good IELTS score
35. C | A provided that | B in case | **C unless**
36. A | **A I'd be able to relax now** | B I'm able to relax now | C I'll be able to relax now
37. C | A stopped | B had stopped | **C would stop**
38. B | A on | **B for** | C to
39. A | **A of** | B on | C for
40. B | A which | **B who** | C what
41. B | A which was founded in 1413 | **B , which was founded in 1413,** | C , that was founded in 1413,
42. C | A What | B That | **C It**
43. C | A the charity is trying to find ways to protect | B to find ways to protect | **C protect**
44. A | **A are recycled** | B recycle | C need recycling
45. B | A I'm fixing my car | **B I'm having my car fixed** | C I need my car fixed
46. A | **A although** | B because | C so
47. C | A However, | B Despite this, | **C In addition,**
48. B | A Frankly | **B Unfortunately** | C Personally

49. C | A Interestingly, | B Definitely, | **C Personally,**

50. A | **A appearance** | B appearing | C appear

Your score: _____ / 50

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Questions adapted from Cambridge Grammar for IELTS (Cambridge University Press)